HAO LI

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics | Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN *2022 – Present (Expected 2027)*

M.S. in Economics | Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN *2023*

Exchange Student – Marketing | ESCE, Paris, France *2020*

B.S. in Insurance (Actuarial Science) | Shandong University of Finance and Economics, China *2018*

RESEARCH FIELDS

Health Economics, Public Economics, Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

When Income Support Hurts and Helps: Health Effects of Survivors Benefits *with Qilu Pan (Job Market Paper, Reject and Resubmit, Journal of Health Economics)*

- This paper explores how income support after widowhood affects health in the short and long run, using Social Security Survivors Benefits as our setting. Exploiting the age-60 eligibility threshold, we use a fuzzy regression discontinuity design and data from the Health and Retirement Study to show that benefit eligibility reduces the probability of reporting good health and increases diagnosed heart disease and diabetes. We find little evidence of changes in health behaviors or high-calorie food spending. Instead, eligibility increases out-of-pocket medical spending and prescription drug use, consistent with benefits relaxing liquidity constraints on medical care and facilitating the detection of previously undiagnosed conditions. We then exploit the 1965 reform that lowered the earliest eligibility age for reduced widow benefits from 62 to 60. Survival to age 70 improved more rapidly among birth cohorts with greater exposure to the reform, with no comparable pattern in Canada. In the United States, all-cause mortality declined more steeply in states with larger pre-reform widow populations. Taken together, the findings are consistent with greater access to medical care contributing to increases in diagnosed illness, while greater exposure to survivors benefits is associated with improved long-run survival.

Survivor Benefits and Intergenerational Transfers: Evidence from Adult Children's Labor Supply

- Using a Regression Kink Design with SIPP and ATUS microdata, I examine how Social Security survivor benefit eligibility at age 60 reshapes resource transfers within families. Eligibility significantly increases financial transfers from widowed parents (aged 55–65) to adult children but leaves time-based caregiving unchanged, suggesting that income effects drive the reallocation. Benefit eligibility also reduces children's working hours. Heterogeneity analysis reveals differential responses by parental health status. I further exploit the Medicare eligibility kink at age 65 to examine how Social Security and Medicare jointly shape these family spillovers.

Effects of the ACA's Dependent Coverage Provision on Young Adults

- The Affordable Care Act's dependent coverage provision allows young adults to remain on their parents' private health insurance until age 26. I estimate its effects on insurance coverage and labor supply using the March Current Population Survey (2008–2013) and a difference-in-differences design comparing adults aged 23–25 to those aged 27–29. The provision raised dependent coverage through parents' plans by 7.1 percentage points, offset by declines in own-employer and individually purchased coverage, with no significant change in the uninsured rate. Gains were larger for males, non-married individuals, and non-students. The provision also reduced the probability of full-time employment by 2.3 percentage points and weekly hours by 0.6, with reductions concentrated among females and non-married individuals; employment and job switching were unaffected. A triple-difference analysis exploiting pre-existing state dependent coverage laws yields no differential effects, indicating that the changes are driven by the federal provision rather than earlier state mandates.

PUBLISHED PAPERS

Emerging Markets' Response to COVID-19: Insights from Arbitrage Strategies
Hao Li, Wang Jialu, Lingdi Zhao, and Xiuqi Guo. *Heliyon, Vol. 10 (2024).*

Optimal Portfolio of Basic Pension Insurance Funds in China
Advances in Social Science, Education and Humanities Research, Vol. 451 (2020)

EXPERIENCE

Instructor – Microeconomics (ECON 251) | Purdue University *Fall & Summer 2025*

- Sole instructor of record; independently designed syllabus, lectures, assignments, and exams for undergraduate students. Held weekly office hours and provided individualized feedback throughout the semester.
- Recognized with the Distinguished Teaching Award.

Teaching Assistant – Econometrics (ECON 674), Health Economics (ECON 537) & Microeconomics (ECON 340) & Real Estate (MGMT 370) | Purdue University *2022 – 2025*

Graduate Research Assistant | Purdue University, Department of Economics *2022 – Present*

- Built end-to-end data pipelines in Python and Stata across 5+ projects — processing 10M+ records from heterogeneous sources (surveys, administrative records, web-scraped data) into analysis-ready datasets.
- Applied causal inference methods to quantify effects of government programs on labor supply, health outcomes, and household finances; findings directly inform benefit program design and policy cost modeling.

Financial Assistant Intern | Beijing Bank *Jun 2021 – Sep 2021*

- Managed investment strategies and risk assessments for ∼¥100M AUM across private clients portfolio; developed customized financial plans using quantitative analysis (OLS modeling, VaR) and qualitative risk profiling.
- Prepared and presented portfolio performance reports and market outlook analyses to senior advisors and high-net-worth clients.

CONFERENCES & PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Participant**, Midwest Health Economics Conference, September 2026
- **Participant**, Workshop: Mechanism Design, Social Choice, and AI, April 2026
- **Presenter and Discussant**, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Conference, November 2025
- **Organizer**, Labor Lunch, Economics Department, Purdue University, 2024 – coordinated weekly research seminars
- **Presenter**, American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference, June 2023
- **Participant**, United Nations Children's Fund Raising Activity, December 2020

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Economics Research Micro-Grant, Purdue University, 2025
- Distinguished Teaching Award, Purdue University, 2025
- Province Outstanding Graduates Award (top 3 of 200), China 2020
- First Prize, Product Design and Company Operations, Paris 2020
- First-class Scholarship, Shandong University of Finance and Economics, 2017 & 2019
- Outstanding Graduate Student Cadres, China 2019
- National Third Place, Risk Management Scheme Design Competition, 9th Risk Management & Actuarial Forum, China 2018
- First Prize, Ergo-life Health Insurance Products Design Contest, 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Stata, Python, MATLAB, SQL, R

REFERENCES

Victoria Prowse (Chair)
Professor of Economics and Marge Magner Chair
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